

Afonso Leote

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🌐 afonsote.github.io

Research Interests

Explainable AI, Neuro-Symbolic AI, transparent, human-centric AI, Mechanistic Interpretability, Fairness in Machine Learning.

Education

- | | |
|----------------|--|
| 2024 – Present | MSc in Computer Science and Engineering
NOVA School of Science and Technology, NOVA University Lisbon
<i>Current GPA: 19/20</i> |
| 2021 – 2024 | BSc in Computer Science and Engineering
NOVA School of Science and Technology, NOVA University Lisbon
<i>Final GPA: 18/20</i> |

Publications

- [1] Manuel de Sousa Ribeiro, **Afonso Leote**, and João Leite **On the Performance of Concept Probing: The Influence of the Data**. In *Procs. of the European Conference on Artificial Intelligence (ECAI'25)*, 2025
- [2] Manuel de Sousa Ribeiro, **Afonso Leote**, and João Leite **Concept Probing: Where to Find Human-Defined Concepts**. In *Procs. of the International Conference on Neurosymbolic Learning and Reasoning (NeSy'25)*, 2025

Honors and Awards

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|-------------|---|
| 2026 | MSc Research Grant
Project FAIR (2024.16987.PEX). |
| 2024 – 2025 | MSc Research Grant
Project PRR STONE (C644943391-00000051/40). |
| 2023 | Top Student Award
NOVA University Lisbon
Awarded to the top students of the university for the 2023–2024 academic year (18.65/20). |
| 2016 | 1st Place Oeiras Internet Challenge '16
Oeiras Valley
First place among all teams from all schools in the Oeiras municipality. |

Research Experience

2024 – Present

Graduate Research Intern

NOVA LINCS, NOVA University Lisbon

During this internship, supervised by Prof. João Leite, we investigated various characteristics relevant to concept probing, focusing on the data involved and the evolution of concept representations throughout neural network models.

2023 – 2024

Undergraduate Research Intern

NOVA LINCS, NOVA University Lisbon

In this internship, supervised by Prof. João Leite, we explored the application of wrapper feature selection methods to pinpoint small sets of neurons representing human-defined concepts within neural network models.

Professional and Community Service

2023

Volunteer Staff at EXPO FCT

Department of Informatics, NOVA University Lisbon

Helped organize, set up, and welcome high school students to the Department of Computer Science, namely in the Artificial Intelligence activity.

Technical skills

Programming Python, R, Java, SQL, JavaScript

Frameworks Pytorch, Tensorflow, Pandas, Git, Azure, Kubernetes

Other Linux, $\text{\LaTeX}$

Languages

Portuguese Native language

English Proficient

Other Activities

2020 – 2023

Escola de Jazz Luiz Villas-Boas (Hot Clube de Portugal)

Music Theory, Ear Training, Piano and Guitar courses